

TEAM BRIEFING — FOUNDING GROUP

The Padel AI Opportunity

Mumbai market read, current statistics, economic playbook, competitive landscape, tie-up prospects, and the technical partner shortlist — brief for the founding team.

PREPARED FOR

Manoj · Aayush · Tanisha

READING TIME

20–25 minutes

COMPANION

Scope Reset — Technical Deltas (follows separately)

AUTHORED

Manoj Maheshwari + AI research · 2026-07-04

1. Executive Summary

Padel is India's fastest-growing racket sport. Mumbai alone has **~44 padel venues and ~80–95 courts** live today, on track for **~140 courts by mid-2027**. Hudle's platform data shows **505 active players per court in Mumbai** — nearly double the national average — and weekend availability is chronically over-subscribed.

Despite this heat, **no AI camera / match-analytics product is live at any Mumbai club today**. The three EU incumbents (Matchlytics in Portugal, SportAI/Padelytics in Norway, SPASH in Spain, plus GameCam globally) have zero India installs. That whitespace is real, and it is closing — SportAI's post-acquisition mandate explicitly names "emerging markets," which puts us on a **12–18 month clock** before an incumbent lands here via a distributor.

Our first anchor is **NSCI (Worli, Mumbai)** — proposal live, awaiting reply — with a 90-day training phase followed by a 2-year commercial phase (30% gross revenue share to the club). NSCI is the credential; the money engine is the network — Padel Park's 5-venue chain, Courtside Worli, and the heritage clubs (Bombay Gymkhana, CCI) that follow the NSCI precedent.

This document is what the founding team (Manoj, Aayush, Tanisha) needs to align on before we spend the next 60 days building. A companion document ("Scope Reset — Technical Deltas") follows separately.

2. The Local Infrastructure

2.1 Venue census — Mumbai

Consolidated from Hudle, KheloMore, Padel Park, Courtside, and press coverage. We identified **~38 commercial padel venues** plus **6 heritage / members clubs** that have added padel.

Commercial venues (top 15 by visibility, 38 total):

#	VENUE	AREA	NOTES
1	Padel Park — Malabar Hill	Priyadarshini Park	Flagship
2	Padel Park — Worli	Lala Lajpatrai Marg	Flagship
3	Padel Park — Cooperage Stadium	Colaba	
4	Padel Park — Bandra (KC Marg)	Bandra	
5	Padel Park — Andheri (Celebrations SC)	Lokhandwala	
6	Courtside Padel Social Club	Atria Mall rooftop, Worli	3 padel + 1 pickleball, invite-only
7	SkyPadel @ Sahara Star	Vile Parle	Indoor
8	Padel Project	Supreme Business Park, Powai	Indoor
9	Padel 360	Worli	
10	Ace Padel Bandra / Ace Padel Andheri	Bandra W / Andheri E	Two sites
11	7Padel × Super Sports Park	Mulund	Premium tier
12	The CourtRoom (R Odeon)	Ghatkopar	Rooftop mall
13	BandrArcade @ Taj Lands End	Bandra	Rooftop
14	Serve Society Kohinoor	Dadar W	
15	Racquet Republic @ Sacred Heart	Khar / Santa Cruz W	

Plus ~23 more mid- and budget-tier venues across Andheri, Powai, Ghatkopar, Bhandup, Mulund, Goregaon, Borivali, and Navi Mumbai.

Heritage members clubs that have added padel:

CLUB	LOCATION	NOTES
NSCI Padel Club	Worli	Our Client #0. 2 courts, members-only.
Cricket Club of India (CCI)	Churchgate	Padel live on Hudle
Willingdon Sports Club	Maali Khata	Padel bookable
Bombay Gymkhana	Fort	Padel court unveiled 2026
Wodehouse Gymkhana	Colaba	Padel live
Breach Candy Swimming Bath Trust	Breach Candy	Padel + pickleball, members-only

2.2 Tier stratification

TIER	RATE/HR	VENUES	FIT FOR PAID AI PRODUCT
Budget	₹400–1,000	Urban Sports network, TSG, PickPad, Radio Club, Padelverse	Low — hardware-included freemium at best
Mid	₹1,500–1,800	Ace Padel, Serve Society, Padel 360, BandrArcade	Good — main paid segment
Premium	₹2,500–3,000+	Padel Project Powai, 7Padel × Super, Courtside Worli	High — brand-conscious, low price sensitivity

Heritage members clubs (NSCI, CCI, Willingdon, Bombay Gymkhana) run ₹10–₹400 subsidised member rates but hold the highest-value roster in the city.

3. Current Statistics

3.1 Growth signal

- **India padel market:** USD 25–30M today → USD 250–300M projected by 2036 (Hudle Report / MediaBrief).
- **Player base:** 100× growth in 3 years → ~1 lakh active players.
- **National courts:** 48 new venues opened Jan–Apr 2026 — annualised ~70% court growth.
- **Investor money:** JSW Sports invested in Padel Park (Aug 2024). A federation-analytics startup raised ₹28 Cr Pre-Series A May 2024 (Centre Court Capital + PeerCapital).

3.2 Absorption / demand pressure

METRIC	MUMBAI	DELHI NCR	INDIA AVG
Active players / court	505	636	305
Avg session length	1.75 hrs	1.75 hrs	1.75 hrs (longest of any Hudle sport)
12-month retention	55%	55%	55%
Games per user / year	9.2	9.2	+73% YoY

Press language across coverage: *"jam-packed like sardines every weekend", "book 5–7 days in advance", "waitlists are the new normal for weekend nights."*

3.3 Padel Park financial anchor (only Indian padel P&L in the public domain)

From Inc42 disclosure — Padel Park FY24:

LINE	VALUE
Revenue	₹2.5 Cr
EBITDA	Positive
MoM revenue growth	20%
Court bookings share	60%
Events & tournaments share	30%
Training / coaching share	10%
Monthly footfall per court	~500 users
Booking lead time	2–3 weeks in advance (fully booked)
Coach training pack	₹8,000–9,000/month/player

Reads: revenue per court ≈ **₹2 lakh/month** at Padel Park. Events + coaching alone = 40% of revenue — this is the layer we can attack with an AI product without disturbing the club's court-rental base.

4. The Opportunity

4.1 GameCam as the benchmark

GameCam (EU, 250+ clubs claimed) pitches a **€900–1,200/court/month** revenue uplift to clubs via analytics subscriptions + AI-court booking premiums. Translated at PPP-adjusted India pricing, that same envelope collapses to **₹65–100K/court/month gross** with a different mix — India can approach the number, but the levers invert: highlights + coaching + tournaments carry more weight; court-booking premium carries less.

4.2 What makes India uniquely attractive vs the EU

1. **Zero incumbent to displace.** No GameCam, no Matchlytics, no PlaySight, no SPASH live in Mumbai. Whiteboard, not a war.
2. **Hopper culture is the norm.** Hudle's whole model is cross-venue booking; players don't stay loyal to one club. This *forces* a player-following network as the product shape — exactly what a new entrant should build, but a legacy club-side product can't.
3. **Demographic density:** padel in Mumbai skews ₹12K+/mo discretionary sport spend, 25–45, urban, HNI-adjacent. One brand deal with Head / Bullpadel / Wilson / Red Bull / HSBC pays for a year of ops.
4. **Coaching underserved:** no Indian padel-coach-discovery layer exists. Padel Park's academy is the closest, but it's their own coaches, their own venues.
5. **NSCI as credential:** once "as used at NSCI" is on the pitch deck, Bombay Gymkhana, CCI, and Willingdon close on governance-envy alone.

4.3 The one non-obvious insight

Players hop. The club doesn't own the player — the peer group does. A camera at a single venue tracks half a player's games. A network of 8–10 venues tracks nearly all of them. The product only becomes valuable at the network level. Which is exactly why an EU incumbent selling club-by-club into India is slower than a local team building the network first.

5. Economics Playbook

5.1 Player affordability today

Court-time cost per player per session (rate ÷ 4 players × 1.75 hrs):

TIER	COURT/HR	PER-PLAYER/SESSION
Budget	₹600–1,000	₹260–440
Mid	₹1,500–1,800	₹655–790
Premium	₹2,500–3,000	₹1,095–1,315

A committed player also spends ₹5–10K/mo on coaching + racquets + apparel.

5.2 Frequency segmentation

Only the **Engaged + Serious + Obsessed** segments (roughly the top 15–25% of a club's roster) will pay for analytics.

SEGMENT	SESSIONS / WK	COURT SPEND / MO (PREMIUM)	NOTES
Curious	0.5	₹2,000–2,600	Try-once corporates, tourists
Casual regular	1	₹4,400–5,200	Weekend social players
Engaged	2	₹8,800–13,000	Core target — improvers, tournament-curious
Serious	3–4	₹13,000–20,000+	Ex-tennis converts, ranking-conscious
Obsessed	5+	₹22,000+	Coach candidates, brand ambassadors

5.3 Subscription tier structure (proposed)

Rule of thumb: 8–12% of primary-activity spend goes to enrichment. Cross-checked against Cult Sport (₹499–999), Cult Pass (₹1,499–2,499), Trackman/Arcos India (₹1,500–2,500), and the international padel benchmark (GameCam player app ~₹950–1,400).

TIER	PRICE / MO	INCLUDES	TARGET
Free	₹0	1 highlight/mo, basic score	Curious/Casual — conversion funnel
Pro	₹499	Unlimited highlights, heatmap, shot mix, spider chart	Engaged — bulk of paid base
Pro+	₹999	Everything + city ranking + opponent scout + coach-shareable link	Serious
Elite / Coached	₹2,499	Personal coach seat, drill prescriptions, monthly review call	Obsessed + parent-of-junior

Blended target ARPU: **~₹650/mo/paying player**. À-la-carte per-match unlock at ₹149 as the entry ramp.

5.4 Revenue mix at maturity (Y2–3, ~40-court network)

STREAM	SHARE	NOTES
Player subscriptions	30%	Recurring, high margin
Per-match unlocks	10%	Casual funnel
Booking take rate	20%	5–7% commission on network bookings
Tournament / ladder fees	15%	Padel Park proves 30% for court-only players — we're leaner
Coach discovery	10%	15% take × ₹8–9K/mo × ~2,000 coached players
Brand sponsorship	15%	Optionality kicker — one deal / quarter / brand

Blended ARPU per active paying player pushes to **₹1,100–1,300/mo** when marketplace layers activate — nearly 2× subscription-only.

5.5 Unit economics — Year 1 Mumbai (indicative)

LINE	ESTIMATE
Venues live end-of-Y1	8–9
Courts live	16–18
Player pool (deduped for hopping)	~5,500 unique
Paid conversion	15%
Paying subs	~825
Blended ARPU	₹650
Subscription revenue / yr	~₹65 L
Per-match unlocks	+40% of sub revenue
Gross topline (subs + unlocks)	₹90 L – 1 Cr
Less 30% club rev-share (NSCI + peers)	~₹27–30 L
Less hardware amortisation (18 courts × ₹1.2L rig ÷ 24 mo)	~₹13 L
Less cloud + team	~₹35–45 L
Net Y1	~break-even to small loss

Year 2 (Delhi NCR replication + coaching upsell + first sponsorship deal) is where the model flips to material profit.

6. Competitive Landscape

Confirmed as of 2026-07-04:

PLAYER	HQ	PRODUCT	INDIA PRESENCE	THREAT LEVEL
Matchlytics (matchlytics.ai) — João Silva	Portugal	Single 180° wide-angle MatchCam + AI + TieSports booking. 7 clubs live. Early.	None	Direct — same architecture, different geography
SportAI + Padelytics (sportai.com)	Norway (acquired 2026)	API + CV infrastructure. Integrations: MATCHi, Save My Play, Rackety. Stated focus: “EU, NA, emerging markets”	None yet	High — best- funded, stated intent
SPASH Match Analyzer (spash.com)	Spain	~20 stats within minutes of match end, no sensors	None	Medium
GameCam / GAMETRAQ (gamecam.io)	EU	Ceiling-mounted 4K/90fps, on-device 12 TOPS AI. 250+ clubs. €900–1,200/court/mo revenue claim	None	Low near-term (hardware complexity), watch
Padex (github.com/rondo- labs/Padex)	Madrid (solo dev)	OSS pipeline — only production-shaped padel CV outside João's. 16★, 61 commits solo. MIT- licensed.	Fork target	Not a competitor — a partner
Padelize, Padelplay	EU	Sensor + app	None	Low

Strategic reads:

- **The window before an EU incumbent enters India is 12–18 months.** SportAI's post-acquisition mandate explicitly names emerging markets. India will not stay whitespace forever.
- **João Silva (Matchlytics) is now a direct competitor**, not a potential collaborator. The Jul 3 outreach is dead — no follow-up. We do not reveal our India plan to any Matchlytics channel.
- **Padex (Dreaner) is the safest OSS foundation** — MIT-licensed, purpose-built for padel, solo dev likely responsive to a paid pilot.
- **JSW Sports has money in Padel Park.** Two possibilities: they become our best distribution partner (5 → 200 sites), or they build the AI layer in-house. Which one depends on who calls whom first, and how ready our proof is when the call happens.

7. Tie-Up Prospects

7.1 Distribution & venue partners (India)

PARTNER	PATH	SIGNAL	FIRST ASK
NSCI (Worli)	Client #0 — proposal live	Awaiting reply. 90-day free training + 2-yr commercial, 30% gross share.	Follow up 2026-07-08 if no reply. Credential secured on signing.
Padel Park network	JSW-backed. 5 Mumbai sites + national franchise pipeline of 200 courts	Owner runs Indian Padel Academy → coaching-tool angle	Approach post-NSCI-live: “we’ve built what your JSW deck probably promised, want to integrate before someone asks you to build it.”
Courtside Padel Social Club (Worli)	Invite-only lifestyle brand	Wellness-brand DNA, has an app	Positioning: member-only Insta-clip feature reinforcing exclusivity
Bombay Gymkhana	Heritage members club, unveiled padel 2026	Committee-buy governance identical to NSCI	Post-NSCI, sell prestige: “the AI system NSCI is running”
CCI (Cricket Club of India)	Padel live	Members-only, ₹200+ subsidised	Same governance pitch as Bombay Gym
Willingdon Sports Club	Padel bookable	Same archetype	Follow-on after Bombay Gym/CCI
Ace Padel Bandra + Andheri	2 mid-tier commercial sites	Bandra + Andheri E footprint	Mid-tier pilot after network alpha
7Padel × Super Sports Park (Mulund)	Premium tier	₹3,000/hr — willing to pay for premium	Sell hardware-free installation in exchange for revenue share

7.2 Platform integrations (India)

PARTNER	VALUE	ASK
Hudle	India's dominant sports-booking platform (Mumbai + Delhi + 18 cities) — the discovery/booking layer everyone hops through	Deep-link booking integration + Hudle-account SSO for PadelMind ID
KheloMore	Secondary booking aggregator	Same integration pattern; lower priority
JSW Sports	Capital + Padel Park distribution	Board observer seat in exchange for 5-site distribution commit?

7.3 White-label / licensing paths (fallback)

If we choose not to build our own CV stack, the three real licensing options:

PRINCIPAL	WHAT WE GET	WHAT WE GIVE	FIT
SportAI (post-Padelytics)	Best-funded, most complete stack, ambitious	25–40% rev-share, brand co-existence, India country-manager style deal	Best strategic fit — they've said "emerging markets"; we're the emerging market they haven't landed in yet
SPASH	Working product, Spanish team, quiet	Similar rev-share	Backup
Matchlytics	João's stack, closest to our thesis	Awkward — competitor + no India intent visible	Skip. Do not approach.

7.4 Brand / sponsor prospects (Y1-Y2)

SPONSOR	FIT	PRODUCT	APPROACH
Head, Bullpadel, Wilson	Padel-native brands	Racquet + gear affiliate	Post-network-alpha
Red Bull	Aspirational sports lifestyle	Tournament title sponsor	Post-city-ranking-launch
HSBC / Standard Chartered	Padel demographic matches private-banking segment	Membership tier co-brand	Post-heritage-club signings
Local sportswear (Boat, Bewakoof, Bombay Shirt Co.)	Match-day apparel	Court-side overlays	Y2 city-ranking sponsor

8. Technical Partner Shortlist

Sourced from GitHub commit graph (stargazers + forkers of Joao-M-Silva/padel_analytics and adjacent racket-sport CV repos), academic authors, and India-diaspora CV engineers. LinkedIn login-wall made direct search low-yield; GitHub was denser signal.

8.1 Priority list — reach out this week

#	CANDIDATE	ROLE / SIGNAL	ASK	CONTACT CHANNEL
1	"Dreaner" / Rondo Labs — author of Padex	Only production-shaped padel-CV OSS besides João's. Solo builder, Madrid, founder DNA. MIT-licensed.	Paid pilot on NSCI courts + equity if it works	github.com/rondo-labs/Padex → GitHub profile → email
2	Amey Narwadkar	Heidelberg Masters (India diaspora). Author of Tennis-Analysis-System (88★). Graduating soon. Tennis-CV is 80% padel-portable.	8-week paid port from tennis to padel + founding-CV-engineer offer post-Masters, Mumbai relocation	github.com/ameynarwadkar
3	Michele Vitale	Whitehall AI Reply consultant (Rome). Author of ball_tracking_padel — cleanest padel ball tracker on GitHub.	4 hrs/mo advisor retainer + small equity slice. Doesn't leave day job.	github.com/michele98
4	Anil John	Indian, starred Joao-M-Silva/padel_analytics — one of only ~5 Indians to do so. Almost certainly a padel player.	30-min coffee. Softest ask, highest hit rate.	github.com/anilujohn

8.2 Second wave — India-based padel-CV stargazers (rare signal)

CANDIDATE	SIGNAL	APPROACH
Gaurav (Gaurav23V) — gaurav23v.app	India, full-stack + ML, 86 repos. Padel_analytics starrer.	Coffee ask + build-partner pitch
Subham Agrawal (Neurabit) — neurabitsolution.com	Runs a CV consultancy in India. Padel_analytics starrer.	Paid POC / delivery partner scope
Akash "sky-akash"	India, 41 repos, padel_analytics starrer	Coffee + early-hire pitch

8.3 Bench — keep warm

- **Muhammad Moin Faisal** (Lahore) — 929 GitHub followers, tennis_analysis, prolific CV tutorials.
- **Harsh Tomar** (@HarshTomar1234, India) — Tennis-Vision 38★, 71 repos across CV/GenAI/MLOps.
- **Nikhil Devanathan** (@nikhil-dev) — `hawkeye` cricket + tennis ball tracking (54★). India-relevant crossover.
- **Fernando Navales Merino** (Granada) — university, padel research hub, potential PhD sourcing channel.
- **Kishore Patlolla** (@kvnptl) — India-born, Germany robotics/CV. Not padel-native but production muscle.
- **TrackNet lineage authors** (Chang-Chia-Chi, alenzenx, yastrebksv, mareksubocz) — racket-sport ball tracking. Twitter DM sweep for Y2 hires.

8.4 Outreach playbook

Each candidate gets a different tone — no template:

- **Dreaner / Padex:** *"Padex is the only production-shaped padel CV pipeline outside of João's. We've locked NSCI Mumbai as our first venue with a 40-court roadmap. Ready to run a paid pilot. Can we cut you a check to deploy Padex on our first two courts, and talk equity if it works?"*
- **Amey:** *"Your YOLO + court-line + ball-speed stack is 80% of what padel needs. NSCI Mumbai is our anchor, 40-court roadmap. Open to an 8-week paid port from tennis to padel, with a founding CV engineer offer in Mumbai after your Masters?"*
- **Michele:** *"Your `ball_tracking_padel` is the cleanest padel ball tracker on GitHub. Not asking you to leave Reply — asking for 4 hrs/month at an advisor rate plus a small equity slice, and access to your dataset annotations under a mutual licence. Interested?"*
- **Anil John:** *"There are five Indians who starred `Joao-M-Silva/padel_analytics`. You're one. I'm another. Coffee or Zoom this week?"*

9. What This Document Doesn't Cover

A companion document — **Scope Reset: Technical Deltas & Commercial Launch Timeline** — is being prepared separately. It addresses:

- Hardware architecture changes (single 180° wide-angle vs multi-camera ceiling rig)
- CV pipeline decision (Padex fork vs licensed stack vs build-from-scratch)
- Product must-haves that shifted from Y2 to Day-1 (cross-venue player ID, Hudle integration, rally detection, gesture-tag highlights)
- Revised commercial-launch milestone: Day 91 NSCI (proof) → Day 180 network commercial launch
- The three strategic paths (build our own · license & wrap · become the master franchisee) with honest tradeoffs and cost envelopes

Read this brief first for alignment on *why* and *where*. Read the Scope Reset next for alignment on *how* and *when*.

10. Immediate Actions (this week)

#	ACTION	OWNER	DEADLINE
1	Follow up NSCI committee if no reply	Manoj	2026-07-08
2	Email Dreaner (Padex) — paid pilot pitch	Manoj + Aayush	2026-07-06
3	Email Amey Narwadkar — founding CV engineer offer	Manoj	2026-07-06
4	Email Michele Vitale — advisor retainer	Manoj	2026-07-06
5	Email Anil John + 3 other Indian padel_analytics stargazers — soft coffee ask	Manoj / Tanisha	2026-07-07
6	Do NOT contact João Silva — competitor, not collaborator	—	Ongoing
7	Team review of Scope Reset companion doc	All three	2026-07-05
8	Decision meeting: Path A (build) vs B (license) vs C (franchise)	All three	2026-07-10

Companion document set: Strategic Venture Plan · Project Report · Technical Feasibility · Commercial Report · Base Club Offer · Technical Review Request.

Single source of truth maintained in `~/Documents/padel-clone/`.